

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This post on city farms appeared on a discussion forum:

Getting back to nature at city farms



Some of you guys probably know about rentable allotments or city farms but I thought I'd share my experience with people new to Hong Kong.

I rent my city farm in Fu Tei near Tuen Mun. I live in the neighbouring village but you can get there from Jordan on the KMB 63X very easily.

Anyway, I rent about 150sqf for 300HKD per month. This price includes the use of all tools and the owner waters the whole farm once or twice a day as needed. She also sells everything else you need.

It is a great community atmosphere and is very busy on Sundays. Some people take it more seriously than others and I have seen some amazing vegetables come out of the ground around here.

There are no real regulations and as long as you don't bother your neighbours nobody cares. Many people have barbecues there.

I've got carrots, beans, choi sum and some herbs planted. I'm never sure what my wife is growing but she has some vegetables growing also!!

Anyway, these allotments are all over the New Territories and you should be able to find them if you're prepared to ask around the locals. Just thought I'd share this bit of info with you all and if anyone would like any further information or to come and have a look, feel free to ask!

Your class teacher is interested in renting a small piece of farmland near your school. He has asked your group to discuss the topic. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits of renting a piece of farmland
- whether students in your class would be interested in having a class farm
- how to organise a class farm
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to grow your own food?
2. Would you like to learn how to grow food?
3. Who would be more interested in farming: young people or older people?
4. Why is renting farmland becoming popular?
5. Do you think you would be good at farming?
6. Should schools teach students more about farming and nature?
7. Why are there so few farms in Hong Kong?
8. Do you think food tastes better if you grow it yourself?